

Quantum Mechanics III

Homework 1

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Topic

Quantum States and Preparation Procedures

Submission

Submit one PDF. Show the derivation, identify every approximation, and include a short consistency check. The maximum file size is 25 MB.

Problems

1. Prove the first displayed relation used in Quantum States and Preparation Procedures. State all assumptions and conventions.

$$\rho \geq 0, \text{Tr} \rho = 1$$

2. Calculate a nontrivial case using the second relation. Carry units and uncertainty where applicable.

$$p(k|P, M) = \text{Tr}(\rho_P E_k)$$

3. Interpret the third relation in two limiting regimes and explain the physical meaning of the result.

$$\gamma = \text{Tr}(\rho^2)$$

Show enough intermediate work that another student can reproduce the calculation.